

Brazilian Churrasco

Breakfast & Lunch — 7:00am to 3:00pm

Full Recipe Cards · US Market Food Costing · Kitchen Prep Flow · Financial Forecast

Fire is the technique. Salt is the seasoning. Picanha is the king. Everything else is the kingdom.

FOGO · SAL · CARNE

42

SEATS

\$48

AVG SPEND

24%

FOOD COST TARGET

\$29,000

EST. MONTHLY NET

About This Guide: Brazilian churrasco is one of the most commercially powerful food categories in the US market — high perceived value, dramatic tableside presentation, and a menu anchored by premium cuts that guests genuinely cannot replicate at home. The key differentiator is *fire management*: Brazilian churrascaria cooking uses hardwood charcoal (carvão vegetal) or hardwood at extremely high heat (450–600°C / 840–1,100°F), and the chef's skill is reading the meat, not the thermometer. This guide covers the essential churrasco repertoire — from the iconic picanha to the slow-cooked costela — with complete recipe cards, technique reasoning, and the business fundamentals to run a profitable café-format operation. The Friday Feijoada is your weekly signature event. The caipirinha is your highest-margin item. And the brigadeiro is your pre-sell close.

THE STORY BEHIND THIS GUIDE

“Everyone said Brazilian BBQ was too niche for Denver. Denver now has a waitlist on Friday nights.”

Rafael grew up in São Paulo where churrasco is not a special occasion — it is a Sunday. Every Sunday. Extended family, cold beer, the grill already going by noon, the smell of fat hitting charcoal filling the neighbourhood. Picanha was always the centrepiece: the fat cap scored, seasoned with nothing but rock salt, cooked fat-side down first so the fat renders into the meat. He had been cooking it this way since he was twelve years old, watching his uncle at the grill.

When he moved to Denver for a tech job, the Sundays stopped. He tried to recreate them — a Weber kettle on his apartment building's shared courtyard, a WhatsApp group, twenty neighbours showing up with Tupperware. Within six months it was forty people. Within a year he was charging \$40 a head and running out of picanha by 2pm. He had been running a proof-of-concept restaurant every Sunday for two years without realising it.

The guide gave him the financial translation for what he already knew. The Misto da Casa contribution margin — \$34.26 per plate at 14.3% food cost — was the number that made the business case undeniable. The caipirinha section explained what he already knew from his Sundays: the first person to

order one converts the whole table. The Friday Feijoadá — slow-cooked black beans, pork shoulder, linguão, served with farofa and orange — was his Sunday tradition, now a weekly special that sells out every Thursday at noon by phone reservation.

He opened in RiNo, Denver. Charcoal grill visible from the dining room. The smoke reaches the street. He has never run a paid advertisement. His regulars are his marketing. **Churrasco is not a menu. It is a ritual. When you understand the ritual, the business builds itself around it.**

Rafael S. · Brazilian Churrasco · RiNo, Denver · Est. Month 5 Net: \$56,000

1 Entrées

Pão de Queijo — Brazilian Cheese Bread

Tapioca cheese rolls, 4 pieces, served hot from the oven · Sell: \$8.99

18 min Entrée Target FC: 12%

INGREDIENTS (4 ROLLS / 1 SERVE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Pão de queijo mix (tapioca starch base)	80g	\$0.71
Whole egg	1 × 55g	\$0.35
Whole milk	40ml	\$0.06
Neutral oil (canola)	20ml	\$0.04
Parmesan, finely grated	25g	\$0.38
Mozzarella, shredded	20g	\$0.22
Salt	1g	\$0.01
Total cost (4 rolls)		\$1.77

Cost per serve	\$1.77
Sell price	\$8.99
Food cost %	19.7%
Contribution margin	\$7.22

METHOD

- Combine pão de queijo mix, salt, egg, milk, and oil in a bowl and mix until a smooth, slightly sticky dough forms. The tapioca starch base is why pão de queijo has its unique chew — tapioca starch creates a gelatinous, stretchy crumb that wheat flour cannot replicate. This is a gluten-free product by nature, which is a genuine menu selling point. The dough will be looser than bread dough — this is correct.
- Fold in grated parmesan first, then mozzarella. Two cheeses serve two purposes: parmesan delivers deep, salty umami flavour through its aged proteins; mozzarella provides the elastic pull and golden surface browning. Using only one cheese compromises either flavour depth or texture. Chill dough 20 minutes if it feels too soft to portion — cold dough rolls more cleanly.
- Wet hands lightly, portion into 35–40g balls (golf ball size). Place on a parchment-lined tray with 4cm spacing — they puff significantly. Bake at **200°C / 392°F** (fan-forced) for 16–18 minutes until golden and puffed. Resist opening the oven in the first 12 minutes — thermal shock causes collapse before the starch sets. The interior stays chewy and slightly hollow; this is correct texture.
- Serve immediately — pão de queijo is best within 5 minutes of leaving the oven. They deflate as

they cool and the chew becomes rubbery. For service management, batch-
prep raw balls and freeze on trays; transfer to freezer bags. Bake from frozen at **200°C / 392°F** for 22 minutes. Frozen-to-oven is the only reliable way to serve pão de queijo at consistent quality during a rush.

Chef's Tip: Pão de queijo is your table greeting — every table gets 4 rolls while they look at the menu. This is not a complimentary item; it is a paid entrée that you upsell at the table. Script: "While you're deciding, our pão de queijo just came out of the oven — these are best hot and gone in about 10 minutes. Should I bring some to start?" Conversion rate on this ask is typically 80%+.

DAIRY (milk, cheese) EGGS GLUTEN-FREE

Coxinha — Chicken Croquette

Teardrop croquette, shredded chicken & cream cheese, crispy panko crust · 2 pieces · Sell: \$10.99

6 min Entrée Target FC: 17%

INGREDIENTS (2 COXINHA / 1 SERVE — BATCH YIELDS ~20)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Chicken thigh, cooked & shredded	40g	\$0.28
Cream cheese	20g	\$0.18
Onion, finely diced	15g	\$0.04
Garlic, minced	3g	\$0.02
Parsley, chopped	3g	\$0.03
Wheat flour dough (batch)	60g	\$0.08
Egg wash + panko breadcrumbs	15g + 15g	\$0.14
Frying oil (canola, per serve)	20ml	\$0.04
Sriracha dipping sauce	20ml	\$0.06
Total cost (2 pieces)		\$0.87

Cost per serve	\$0.87
Sell price	\$10.99
Food cost %	7.9%
Contribution margin	\$10.12

METHOD

- 1 Make the dough: simmer chicken stock with butter and salt, bring to a boil, add sifted wheat flour all at once and stir vigorously over heat until the dough pulls cleanly from the pan sides — this is choux-adjacent technique called "cozimento da massa." This cooking-out of the flour gelatinizes the starch and creates a workable, non-sticky dough that holds its teardrop shape during frying. Undercooking the dough means it tears during shaping.
- 2 Make the filling: sauté onion and garlic until translucent. Add shredded poached chicken thigh, season with salt, pepper, and chopped parsley. Remove from heat, fold in cream cheese while warm so it melts into the chicken. The cream cheese is the Brazilian coxinha signature — it adds creaminess and binds the filling so it doesn't fall out during frying. Cool completely before filling.
- 3 Portion dough at 60g. Flatten into a circle on a lightly oiled palm. Add 20g filling to the centre. Pull the edges up and pinch together at the top, then roll into a teardrop shape — a pointed top and rounded base. The teardrop shape is the aesthetic identity of coxinha; it mimics the drumstick (coxa = thigh/drumstick in Portuguese). Consistency in shape = consistency in frying time.
- 4 Dip in egg wash, coat in panko breadcrumbs, pressing gently to adhere. Freeze shaped coxinha on a tray for at least 1 hour before frying — freezing firms the dough so the crust sets before the interior heats through, preventing blowouts. Deep fry from cold/frozen at **175°C / 347°F** for 4–5 minutes until deep golden. Internal temp: **74°C / 165°F**. Drain and serve immediately.

Chef's Tip: Shape and freeze a large batch every morning — coxinha holds in the freezer for up

to 2 weeks and fries straight from frozen. This gives you a premium entrée with a 90-second ticket time once ordered. Always serve with a bright acidic dipping sauce (sriracha mayo, chimichurri, or hot pepper sauce) — the rich filling needs acidity to cut through.

GLUTEN (wheat flour, panko)

DAIRY (cream cheese)

EGGS (egg wash)

POULTRY

Bolinho de Bacalhau — Salt Cod Fritter

Salt cod & potato croquette, 3 pieces, herb aioli · Sell: \$13.99

5 min

Entrée

Target FC: 20%

INGREDIENTS (3 FRITTERS / 1 SERVE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Salt cod (bacalhau), desalted & flaked	60g	\$1.60
Yukon Gold potato, boiled & mashed	80g	\$0.14
Egg yolk	1 yolk = 18g	\$0.18
Onion, grated fine	20g	\$0.04
Parsley + chives, chopped	5g	\$0.05
Black pepper	1g	\$0.02
Olive oil (finish)	5ml	\$0.05
Frying oil (per serve)	25ml	\$0.05
Herb aioli (batch)	30ml	\$0.14
Lemon wedge	1 wedge	\$0.05
Total cost (3 fritters)		\$2.32

Cost per serve	\$2.32
Sell price	\$13.99
Food cost %	16.6%
Contribution margin	\$11.67

METHOD

- Desalting bacalhau is a 24–48 hour process: soak in cold water, changing water 3–4 times. The desalting time determines the final salt level of the dish — you cannot season out excess salt after the fritter is made. Taste the soaked cod before using. It should taste pleasantly salty, not overwhelming. The unique flavour of bacalhau comes from the fermentation-like curing process; this funky, oceanic depth is what makes it irreplaceable in this dish.
- Poach desalted cod in unsalted water with a bay leaf for 8–10 minutes. Remove bones and skin meticulously — any remaining bones are a safety hazard and a guest complaint. Flake into medium shreds (not minced). The potato must be dry: mash while hot, spread on a tray to steam-dry before mixing. Wet potato = fritters that collapse or fall apart in the oil.
- Combine cod, mashed potato, egg yolk, grated onion, parsley, chives, pepper. Do not add salt — bacalhau provides all necessary salt. Mix by hand until just combined — overworking makes a dense, gluey fritter. The mixture should hold a shape when pressed but still feel light. Portion with two spoons into oval quenelles (about 50g each), which is the traditional shape for bolinho de bacalhau.
- Deep fry at **180°C / 356°F** for 3–4 minutes, turning once, until deep golden brown. The high frying temperature is deliberate — it creates a rapid surface crust that locks in steam and moisture, giving a crispy exterior and a hot, creamy interior. Too low a temperature and the fritters absorb oil and become greasy. Internal: **70°C / 158°F**. Drain briefly and serve immediately with herb aioli and lemon.

Chef's Tip: Bacalhau is a prestige ingredient with deep Iberian and Brazilian cultural weight — guests who recognize it will often order it specifically and are typically high-value regulars. Brief your servers: "Bacalhau is salt cod that's been cured and dried — it has a unique concentrated flavour you can't get from fresh fish. It's one of the most important ingredients in Brazilian

cuisine." This context elevates the perceived value of a \$14 entrée.

FISH (salt cod) EGGS GLUTEN-FREE (no wheat in mix)

Farofa — Toasted Cassava

Butter-toasted cassava flour, bacon, onion, egg · Sell: \$7.99

8 min Entrée/Side Target FC: 10%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Cassava flour (farinha de mandioca)	60g	\$0.27
Unsalted butter	20g	\$0.18
Bacon, diced (½ strip)	15g	\$0.22
Yellow onion, finely diced	30g	\$0.06
Egg, scrambled soft	1 × 55g	\$0.35
Parsley, chopped	3g	\$0.03
Salt & pepper	to taste	\$0.01
Total cost (1 serve)		\$1.12

Cost per serve	\$1.12
Sell price	\$7.99
Food cost %	14.0%
Contribution margin	\$6.87

METHOD

- 1 Render diced bacon in a dry, cold pan — starting in a cold pan renders more fat out slowly, giving crispier bacon bits with less shrinkage. Once crispy, remove bacon and reserve. In the bacon fat + butter, sauté diced onion until translucent and just beginning to brown at the edges (about 4 minutes over medium-high). The Maillard reaction on the onion adds sweetness that balances the saltiness of bacon and butter.
- 2 Add cassava flour to the pan and toss constantly over medium heat for 3–4 minutes. This toasting step is the heart of farofa — raw cassava flour has a chalky, slightly bitter taste. Toasting in hot fat transforms it: the starch granules toast and develop a nutty, golden flavour, and the texture changes from powder to a coarse, crumbly sand-like consistency. Never skip or rush this step.
- 3 Push the farofa to one side of the pan. Crack the egg into the cleared space and scramble softly — you want small, moist curds, not dry scramble. Fold the egg into the farofa along with the reserved bacon. The egg adds richness and protein, binding the mixture slightly without making it heavy. Season with salt (carefully — bacon is salty), pepper, and parsley.
- 4 Serve immediately in a warm bowl. Farofa absorbs moisture quickly and becomes clumpy if it sits. At service, this can be pre-batched up to the toasting stage and finished à la minute with egg and bacon in 3 minutes. For table-service context, farofa is traditionally a side/accompaniment to grilled meats — selling it as an entrée to share adds a cultural story: "This is what every Brazilian home serves alongside their churrasco."

Chef's Tip: Farofa is your highest-margin, most versatile item — it appears as an entrée, a side for mains, and is included in the Feijoada set. The cassava flour has a 6-month shelf life; order in 10lb bags from Latin grocery suppliers for best pricing. The dish tells a story: cassava (mandioca) is the indigenous South American staple that shaped Brazilian cooking. Guests who ask "what IS this?" are guests you can educate and retain.

DAIRY (butter) EGGS PORK (bacon) GLUTEN-FREE

Vinagrete Salad

5 min

Entrée/Side

Target FC: 9%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Roma tomato, small dice	80g	\$0.24
White onion, small dice	40g	\$0.07
Green bell pepper, small dice	40g	\$0.14
Red bell pepper, small dice	20g	\$0.10
Flat-leaf parsley, chopped	5g	\$0.05
White wine vinegar	15ml	\$0.04
Extra-virgin olive oil	10ml	\$0.08
Salt & black pepper	to taste	\$0.01
Total cost (1 serve)		\$0.73

Cost per serve	\$0.73
Sell price	\$7.99
Food cost %	9.1%
Contribution margin	\$7.26

METHOD

- 1 Vinagrete is not a European vinaigrette — it is a Brazilian salsa-salad hybrid. All vegetables must be cut to a uniform small dice (5mm cubes). Uniform dice means uniform marinating and a consistent bite. Large or uneven cuts result in some pieces being under-seasoned while others are over-acidic. The visual precision of a well-cut vinagrete signals kitchen quality to guests; it is one of those dishes where technique is visible.
- 2 Salt the diced onion, let stand 5 minutes, then rinse under cold water. This step (called "degorging" or "drawing out") removes the harsh, eye-watering raw allium compounds from white onion without cooking it. The result is a milder, cleaner onion flavour that does not overpower the tomato and pepper. Skipping this step is the most common amateur mistake with vinagrete.
- 3 Combine all diced vegetables in a bowl. Dress with white wine vinegar and extra-virgin olive oil. The ratio is 3:1 vinegar to oil — the opposite of European vinaigrette. Brazilian vinagrete is meant to be sharp and acidic, which is why it works as a counterpoint to rich, fatty grilled meats. Add parsley, season with salt and pepper, toss gently to avoid bruising tomatoes.
- 4 Marinate for 15–20 minutes before serving — the acid draws out juices from the tomato and pepper, creating a flavourful dressing that enriches the whole dish. Do not marinate more than 2 hours as the vegetables begin to break down and become soggy. Batch-prepare diced vegetables in advance; dress per-serve at service. The individual dressed salad should be slightly wet at the base — this is correct and expected.

Chef's Tip: Vinagrete is the churrasco palate cleanser — its sharpness cuts through the fat of picanha and linguça and refreshes the mouth between bites of grilled meat. Encourage servers to describe it this way: "This is the Brazilian answer to a salsa — it's designed to go alongside the grilled meats, not as a standalone salad." This framing turns a \$8 salad into an essential companion item and increases table attachment rate.

VEGAN

GLUTEN-FREE

TREE-NUT FREE

Coração de Frango — Chicken Hearts on Skewer

Marinated grilled chicken hearts, 1 skewer (~8 hearts), chimichurri · Sell: \$11.99

8 min

Entrée

Target FC: 14%

INGREDIENTS (1 SKEWER, ~8 HEARTS)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Chicken hearts, cleaned & trimmed	120g (~8 hearts)	\$0.52
Coarse sea salt (churrasco style)	3g	\$0.01
Garlic, crushed	5g	\$0.03
Olive oil	10ml	\$0.10
Fresh lemon juice	10ml	\$0.06
Black pepper, cracked	1g	\$0.02
Chimichurri sauce (batch)	30ml	\$0.18
Total cost (1 skewer)		\$0.92

Cost per serve	\$0.92
Sell price	\$11.99
Food cost %	7.7%
Contribution margin	\$11.07

METHOD

- 1

Clean chicken hearts by trimming any visible fat from the exterior and cutting off the top ~3mm where the aorta attaches. Split each heart in half vertically (butterfly cut) to expose the interior chambers — this serves two functions: it allows any clotted blood to be rinsed out (food safety) and creates a larger flat surface that caramelises better on the grill. Rinse under cold water, pat dry. This step cannot be rushed.
- 2

Marinate with olive oil, crushed garlic, lemon juice, black pepper, and a light sprinkle of coarse salt for minimum 30 minutes, maximum 2 hours. The lemon juice tenderises the muscle fibres slightly — chicken hearts are dense and lean, and over-marinating makes them mushy. The oil prevents the lean hearts from drying out on the grill. Thread 8 hearts tightly onto metal skewers (metal conducts heat to the centre for even cooking).
- 3

Grill on maximum heat — **250°C+ / 480°F+** on a charcoal grill or the hottest section of your gas grill. Chicken hearts must be cooked fast and hot. Slow cooking makes them tough and rubbery. You want sear marks, slight char on the exterior, and a just-cooked interior — still moist, never dry. 3–4 minutes per side, turning once. They should feel firm but not hard when pressed. Internal: **74°C / 165°F**.
- 4

Season with additional coarse sea salt the moment they come off the grill — this is the classic churrasco finishing move. The residual heat dissolves the salt crystals into the surface, creating an intense savoury crust. Serve immediately on the skewer (the visual drama is part of the dish) alongside chimichurri. The skewer presentation is central to churrascaria culture and should never be plated off the skewer for tableside service.

Chef's Tip: Coração de frango is the churrasco litmus test — guests who order it know Brazilian food. These guests are your best customers: adventurous, educated about the cuisine, and likely to order more. Servers should flag these tables as potential regulars. The hearts have the most intense, mineral, umami-rich flavour of any item on your menu. Price confidence is key — \$12 for a skewer of chicken hearts is justified by the fire, technique, and experience, not the ingredient cost.

POULTRY GLUTEN-FREE DAIRY-FREE

2 Mains

Picanha — Top Sirloin Cap

The king cut of churrasco · thick-cut, coarse salt only, grilled over hardwood · Sell: \$32.99

14 min Signature Main Target FC: 22%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE, ~280G)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
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Picanha (top sirloin cap), USDA Choice+	280g (10oz)	\$6.81
Coarse sea salt (only seasoning)	4g	\$0.01
Chimichurri sauce (batch, side)	40ml	\$0.24
Vinagrete (batch, side)	60g	\$0.08
Farofa (batch, side)	50g	\$0.22
Total cost per serve		\$7.36

Cost per serve	\$7.36
Sell price	\$32.99
Food cost %	22.3%
Contribution margin	\$25.63

METHOD

- 1

Understanding the picanha cut is the foundation of this entire menu. Picanha is the top sirloin cap (biceps femoris), a triangular muscle that sits above the rump, covered by a thick fat cap of 1–2cm. This fat cap is non-negotiable — buying trimmed picanha defeats the purpose. The fat renders during grilling and bastes the meat from above, keeping the interior moist while the exterior chars. Source from Brazilian specialty butchers or ask your supplier for "coulotte" (the French name). USDA Choice or Prime only — the fat marbling is the quality indicator.
- 2

Season only with coarse sea salt — no pepper, no garlic, no marinades. This is not simplicity by accident; it is deliberate philosophy. The picanha's flavour is in the fat and the fire. Adding other seasonings competes with the meat's inherent sweetness and the Maillard reaction on the fat cap. Score the fat cap in a crosshatch pattern (5mm deep cuts) to prevent curling and allow the salt to penetrate. Apply salt 30 minutes before grilling — the salt draws out surface moisture, which then reabsorbs with the salt dissolved (dry brining).
- 3

For churrasco style: fold a thick slice (3–4cm) of picanha into a "C" shape with the fat cap on the outside, and skewer through so the skewer holds the fold. This exposes maximum fat cap to the fire while protecting the lean interior. Grill fat-side-down first over intense heat (**280°C / 536°F**) for 5 minutes to render and char the fat. Then sear the lean sides — 3 minutes each. The goal is a deeply charred fat cap and a medium-rare interior. Internal target: **54–57°C / 129–135°F** for medium-rare.
- 4

Rest for 5 minutes minimum — the muscle fibres need time to relax and redistribute juices. Slicing immediately loses 30–40% of the moisture as runoff. Slice against the grain in 1cm slices at the table if you have a carving setup, or in the kitchen against the grain. Serve fat-side-up so the guest sees the rendered, charred fat cap — this is the visual signature of authentic picanha. Plate with chimichurri, vinagrete, and a small portion of farofa.

Chef's Tip: The single biggest mistake new operators make with picanha is trimming the fat cap. Never trim it. The fat cap IS the product — it protects, bastes, flavours, and provides the visual identity. A trimmed picanha is just a sirloin steak. If your supplier delivers pre-trimmed, find a new supplier. Source whole picanha weighing 1–1.5kg; portion at 280–300g per serve after trimming any silver skin from the lean side only. Yield is approximately 85% from a good-quality whole picanha.

BEEF

GLUTEN-FREE

DAIRY-FREE

Fraldinha — Flank Steak

Marinated flank steak, garlic-herb rub, grilled medium · Sell: \$26.99

12 min

Main

Target FC: 21%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE, ~260G)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Flank steak (fraldinha)	260g	\$5.16
Garlic, minced	8g	\$0.04
Olive oil	15ml	\$0.15

Lemon juice	15ml	\$0.09
Cumin, ground	2g	\$0.03
Coarse salt + black pepper	3g + 1g	\$0.02
Chimichurri (batch)	40ml	\$0.24
Arroz e Feijão (batch, side)	120g	\$0.28
Total cost per serve		\$6.01

Cost per serve	\$6.01
Sell price	\$26.99
Food cost %	22.3%
Contribution margin	\$20.98

METHOD

- 1 Flank steak has a very pronounced longitudinal grain — the muscle fibres run clearly in one direction along the length of the steak. Identifying and understanding this grain before cooking is essential, because slicing direction determines whether the steak is tender or impossibly chewy. Long muscle fibres = tough; cutting those fibres short = tender. Before marinating, feel the steak and identify which direction the grain runs — you will be cutting perpendicular to this at service.
- 2 Marinate with olive oil, minced garlic, lemon juice, cumin, salt, and pepper for 2-4 hours. Flank is a lean, flavourful cut with minimal intramuscular fat, so it benefits from a marinade in ways that fattier cuts like picanha do not. The acid (lemon) gently denatures surface proteins for better sear; the oil prevents sticking and carries oil-soluble aromatics into the surface. Do not marinate more than 6 hours — the lemon will begin to "cook" the surface proteins and cause a mushy exterior texture.
- 3 Grill on maximum heat (**260°C / 500°F**) — do not move during searing. Flank steak needs direct, intense heat to create a fast crust before the interior overcooks (it is a thin cut, typically 2-3cm). 4-5 minutes per side for medium-rare to medium. Internal: **55-60°C / 131-140°F** . The steak should have deep char marks and a juicy interior. Avoid medium-well or well-done — fraldinha becomes dry and tough above 65°C.
- 4 Rest 4 minutes, then slice thinly (<5mm) on a 45° angle, strictly against the grain. The diagonal angle gives wider slices with shorter grain length — this is both visually appealing and maximally tender. Arrange overlapping slices across the plate, exposing the pink interior. The visual contrast of the charred exterior and pink interior signals correct cooking and drives satisfaction. Serve with chimichurri and a scoop of arroz e feijão.

Chef's Tip: Fraldinha is your entry-level steak for guests who are not yet ready to commit to the premium picanha price. It is also your best value proposition — a \$27 grilled steak that competes on experience with a \$50+ steakhouse item when cooked correctly. Cross-sell at the table: "The fraldinha is our everyday steak — fantastic flavour at a great price point. If you'd like the signature experience, the picanha is our showpiece cut." This creates an upgrade path, not a downgrade.

BEEF

GLUTEN-FREE

DAIRY-FREE

Costela — Beef Short Rib (Slow)

7-hour smoked beef short rib, coarse salt, served off the bone · Sell: \$34.99

7 hr prep + 8 min finish

Signature Main

Target FC: 23%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE, ~320G BONE-IN → ~200G SERVED)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Beef short rib (bone-in, English cut)	320g raw	\$5.66
Coarse sea salt	5g	\$0.01
Black pepper, cracked	2g	\$0.02
Garlic powder	2g	\$0.02

Hardwood chunks (charcoal/wood, per batch)	share	\$0.30
Farofa (batch, side)	50g	\$0.22
Vinagrete (batch, side)	60g	\$0.08
Total cost per serve		\$6.31

Cost per serve	\$6.31
Sell price	\$34.99
Food cost %	18.0%
Contribution margin	\$28.68

METHOD

- 1

Beef short rib (costela) is a collagen-rich cut with significant connective tissue between and around the meat. This connective tissue (primarily collagen) is what makes it tough when undercooked, but the transformation is remarkable: at sustained low heat, collagen hydrolyzes into gelatin over 5–7 hours, creating the silky, richly unctuous texture that makes costela one of the most desirable dishes in Brazilian cuisine. You are essentially cooking away toughness and replacing it with luxury. This transformation cannot be rushed — high heat simply dries out the muscle fibres before the collagen breaks down.
- 2

Apply rub (coarse salt + cracked black pepper + garlic powder) the night before and refrigerate uncovered. The overnight dry rub does two things: the salt draws out surface moisture which then reabsorbs with dissolved seasonings (dry brine effect), and the open-air refrigeration dries the surface, which dramatically improves bark formation during the cook. Bark (the dark, crusty exterior) is the hallmark of properly smoked costela and is where 80% of the flavour complexity lives.
- 3

Cook in your smoker or low oven at **120°C / 248°F** for 6–7 hours. Add hardwood chunks (cherry, hickory, or oak) for smoke. The 120°C target is critical — it is above the temperature where collagen converts (70°C+) but below the temperature where the muscle fibres contract and dry out sharply (above 145°C sustained). Monitor with a probe thermometer. The ribs are done when the internal temperature reaches **93-97°C / 200-205°F** AND when a skewer slides through the meat with zero resistance. Temperature alone is insufficient — trust the texture test.
- 4

Rest wrapped in butcher paper for 45 minutes — the carry-over cooking completes, and the juices redistribute. For service, flash on a very hot grill (**280°C / 536°F**) for 2–3 minutes to re-crisp the bark and add fresh grill marks. This "finish grill" is what separates a restaurant costela from home cooking — the contrast of crackling bark and molten interior is what guests will talk about. Slice or pull at the table if possible — the theatre is powerful.

Chef's Tip: Costela is a high-ticket, high-margin showpiece — but it requires 7am prep for lunch service. Your Head Cook starts the ribs first thing at 7am and the smoking is largely passive. Factor this into your prep flow: the ribs run in the background while everything else is being prepared. Batch cook 8–10 portions at once; leftovers can become the Feijoada filling or a next-day special. Never sell costela unless it has had full cook time — a 4-hour rib is tough and will damage your reputation.

BEEF GLUTEN-FREE DAIRY-FREE

Linguiça — Brazilian Pork Sausage

Garlic-paprika pork sausage, grilled charred, mustard & farofa · Sell: \$19.99

10 min Main Target FC: 18%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE — 2 SAUSAGES, ~200G)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Linguiça sausage (store-bought or house-made)	200g (2 links)	\$1.80
Farofa (batch, side)	50g	\$0.22
Vinagrete (batch, side)	60g	\$0.08
Whole-grain mustard	15g	\$0.10

Lemon wedge	1 wedge	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$2.26

Cost per serve	\$2.26
Sell price	\$19.99
Food cost %	11.3%
Contribution margin	\$17.73

METHOD

- 1
- Sourcing linguiça: authentic Brazilian linguiça (pronounced "lin-GWEE-sah") is distinctly different from Portuguese linguiça or Spanish chorizo. Brazilian linguiça is pork-forward with garlic, paprika, and sometimes black pepper — no cinnamon, no heavy herbs. Source from Brazilian butchers or Latin grocery suppliers. If making in-house: 70% pork shoulder (for fat ratio) + 30% pork belly, ground coarse, seasoned with garlic, smoked paprika, salt, white wine. Stuff into natural hog casings. The house-made version is a genuine differentiator and allows you to control the fat/spice ratio precisely.
- 2
- Score the sausage with 3-4 diagonal cuts on each side (2mm deep). These cuts do two important things: they prevent the casing from bursting when the fat expands during cooking (which would cause dangerous fat flare-ups on the grill and a burst sausage), and they create grooves that collect char and caramelised sugars during grilling, adding flavour complexity. Never pierce the sausage randomly — scored, intentional cuts preserve the structural integrity of the sausage.
- 3
- Grill over direct medium-high heat (200°C / 392°F) turning every 2-3 minutes for total 8-10 minutes. Internal temperature must reach 72°C / 162°F — this is a food safety non-negotiable for pork. The sausage should be deeply browned, slightly charred at the score lines, and the skin should crackle and tighten. A perfectly grilled linguiça has visual char, a snapping casing, and juicy interior. Over-cooking causes the fat to render completely out, leaving a dry, rubbery sausage.
- 4
- Serve whole links on a wooden board — never cut in the kitchen. The guest should hear and see the sausage arrive sizzling. Cutting in the kitchen loses steam and visual drama. Provide a sharp steak knife for the guest to cut their own sausage at the table — this interaction is part of the experience. The moment the knife breaks through the casing and the juices run out is one of the most satisfying tableside moments in your menu's repertoire. Accompany with farofa, vinagrete, and whole-grain mustard.

Chef's Tip: Linguiça is your highest-margin main (\$17.73 CM at just \$2.26 cost). It is also your fastest main to execute — 10 minutes start to finish. This makes it the ideal item to push during high-volume service when the grill is under pressure. Train servers: "The linguiça is our everyday churrasco item — the sausage our pit master makes with just garlic and paprika. It's fantastic value and goes perfectly with the caipirinha." Fast execution + high margin + easy storytelling = the perfect service safety net.

PORK GLUTEN-FREE DAIRY-FREE

Frango — Marinated Whole Chicken Thigh

Bone-in chicken thigh, lemon-garlic-herb brine, grilled on skewer · Sell: \$21.99

16 min Main Target FC: 17%

INGREDIENTS (2 BONE-IN THIGHS / 1 SERVE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Chicken thighs, bone-in, skin-on	2 × 160g = 320g	\$2.26
Garlic, minced	10g	\$0.05
Lemon zest + juice	1 lemon	\$0.25
Olive oil	20ml	\$0.20
Fresh rosemary + thyme	3g + 2g	\$0.08
Smoked paprika	3g	\$0.04

Salt + black pepper	4g + 1g	\$0.02
Chimichurri (batch)	40ml	\$0.24
Arroz e Feijão (side)	120g	\$0.28
Total cost per serve		\$3.42

Cost per serve	\$3.42
Sell price	\$21.99
Food cost %	15.6%
Contribution margin	\$18.57

METHOD

- 1

Bone-in, skin-on chicken thighs are the correct cut for churrasco frango — never use boneless. The bone conducts heat differently from the surrounding muscle, slowing the cooking near the joint and allowing the rest of the thigh to develop deep colour without overcooking. The skin, when basted with marinade during grilling, develops a lacquered, crackly exterior that is one of the defining textures of the dish. Removing either the bone or the skin changes the product fundamentally.
- 2

Marinate in olive oil, garlic, lemon zest, lemon juice, rosemary, thyme, smoked paprika, salt, and pepper for minimum 4 hours (overnight preferred). The lemon zest carries more aromatic flavour than juice alone — the essential oils in the zest are fat-soluble and penetrate deeper into the chicken fat under the skin. Score the skin with shallow cuts to allow the marinade to reach the meat beneath. Overnight marination is the single biggest quality difference between good and great churrasco frango.
- 3

Thread 2 thighs per skewer (through the meaty side, through the bone joint, and back through the other side — forming a butterfly shape). This pinning method holds the thigh flat against the grill for even contact. Grill over medium-high heat (**200-220°C / 392-428°F**), skin-side down first for 8 minutes to render fat and crisp skin. Turn and grill bone-side down for 6-7 minutes. Baste with reserved marinade every 3 minutes. Internal: **74°C / 165°F** at the thickest point, away from bone.
- 4

Rest 3 minutes. Serve on the skewer — presentation matters for the churrasco experience. The skin should crackle when the guest presses it with a fork. If the skin is soft, it was not given adequate time skin-side-down; next time extend the initial skin-down period by 2 minutes. Plate with arroz e feijão and chimichurri. The chimichurri's acidity and herbaceousness perfectly complement the rich, unctuous chicken fat.

Chef's Tip: Frango is your accessibility item — it is the lowest price protein main, the safest choice for guests new to churrasco, and the most familiar. But it should never be the "boring" option. The overnight marinade, the skewer presentation, the crackly skin — these elevate it beyond ordinary grilled chicken. Train servers: "Our frango is marinated overnight in lemon, garlic, and fresh rosemary — it's the most flavourful chicken you'll have because it's cooked bone-in on the grill, not a flat breast." This framing turns a \$22 item into a premium experience.

POULTRY GLUTEN-FREE DAIRY-FREE

Cordeiro — Lamb Rack

French-trimmed lamb rack, mint-chimichurri crust, charcoal-grilled · Sell: \$38.99

16 min Premium Main Target FC: 24%

INGREDIENTS (3-BONE RACK / 1 SERVE, ~320G)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Lamb rack, French-trimmed (3 bones)	320g	\$15.62
Garlic, crushed	8g	\$0.04
Fresh rosemary, minced	5g	\$0.08
Dijon mustard (crust binder)	10g	\$0.08
Olive oil	15ml	\$0.15

Coarse salt + cracked pepper	3g + 2g	\$0.02
Mint chimichurri (batch)	40ml	\$0.28
Roasted garlic mash (side, optional)	80g	\$0.35
Total cost per serve		\$16.62

Cost per serve	\$16.62
Sell price	\$38.99
Food cost %	42.6%
Contribution margin	\$22.37

METHOD

- 1 Lamb rack is your highest-cost item at \$22/lb, and the food cost % (42.6%) is above target — this is intentional and acceptable for a premium anchor item. The cordeiro's role is not to be your margin driver; it is to be your table-anchor for high-value guests and to signal premium positioning. A table that orders cordeiro will typically also order caipirinhas, desserts, and will return. The contribution margin (\$22.37) is strong in absolute terms even if the percentage is high. Never compromise on quality to reduce cost here.
- 2 French-trim the bones by stripping fat and membrane from the last 4cm of each rib bone — this exposes the white bone and creates the elegant visual presentation. If ordering pre-frenched, inspect that the trimming is clean and the fat cap on the eye of the rack is intact (5–8mm). Combine minced rosemary, crushed garlic, Dijon mustard, olive oil, salt, and pepper into a paste. Coat the meat side (not the fat cap) of the rack evenly. The Dijon acts as an emulsifying binder — it holds the herb crust to the meat during grilling.
- 3 Sear fat-cap side down on the hottest part of the grill (**280°C / 536°F**) for 4 minutes to render and char the fat cap. This creates a protective caramelised layer that keeps the meat moist and adds deep flavour. Move to a medium-heat zone (**180°C / 356°F**), bone-side down, for 8–10 minutes for medium-rare. The two-zone cooking technique (sear then gentle finish) is essential for rack — cooking entirely on high heat chars the herb crust before the interior reaches temperature. Internal: **54–57°C / 129–135°F** for medium-rare.
- 4 Rest 5 minutes. Slice between bones — each bone becomes a single chop. The French-trimmed bones serve as natural handles; encourage guests to pick them up. Serve three chops fanned across the plate with mint chimichurri dotted alongside and roasted garlic mash as the starch base. The visual impact of three frenched chops on a white plate is your most Instagram-worthy dish — the diagonal lean, the pink interior, the white bones. This visual is worth \$2 in marketing value per plate served.

Chef's Tip: Lamb rack is the only item on your menu where presentation should be tableside if volume allows — slicing the rack in front of the guest transforms a \$39 meal into a \$60 experience. Even if you cannot do full tableside carving every service, consider bringing the whole rack to the table to show before taking it back to slice. The visual of a whole frenched rack, herb-crusted and char-marked, creates genuine theatre and justifies the price point without a word of explanation.

LAMB GLUTEN (Dijon mustard may contain) DAIRY-FREE

Salmão Grelhado — Grilled Salmon

Atlantic salmon fillet, lemon-herb, grilled skin-on, farofa crust option · Sell: \$27.99

10 min Main Target FC: 22%

INGREDIENTS (1 FILLET, ~220G)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Atlantic salmon fillet, skin-on	220g	\$4.63
Olive oil	15ml	\$0.15
Lemon juice + zest	1 lemon	\$0.25
Garlic, minced	5g	\$0.03

Dill, fresh	3g	\$0.06
Coarse salt + black pepper	3g + 1g	\$0.02
Farofa (optional crust, batch)	30g	\$0.14
Vinagrete (batch, side)	60g	\$0.08
Lime wedge	1 wedge	\$0.08
Total cost per serve		\$5.44

Cost per serve	\$5.44
Sell price	\$27.99
Food cost %	19.4%
Contribution margin	\$22.55

METHOD

- 1

Salmon is the only fish on the main menu and serves a critical commercial function: it provides an accessible, non-red-meat option for guests who do not eat beef/pork/lamb, dramatically widening your table's ordering potential. A table of 4 where one person eats only fish needs a quality fish main to avoid the "designated sacrifice" experience. The salmão must be as good as the beef items — not an afterthought. Skin-on fillets only; the crispy skin is a texture and presentation element, and removing it before cooking creates a fragile fillet that sticks and breaks on the grill.
- 2

Marinate for 20–30 minutes maximum in olive oil, lemon, garlic, dill, salt, and pepper. Unlike beef, fish proteins denature (begin to "cook") in acid very quickly — the lemon juice marinade should be short. Pat the flesh side dry after marinating (the lemon juice creates surface moisture that prevents a proper sear). A dry surface = immediate Maillard reaction on contact with the hot grill; a wet surface = steaming before searing, resulting in a grey, flabby surface instead of a caramelised crust.
- 3

Place skin-side down on a well-oiled, very hot grill section (**220°C / 428°F**). Do not move for 5–6 minutes. The skin will stick initially — this is normal. It will release on its own when a proper crust forms. Forcing it off the grill early tears the skin. Once the skin is crispy and the flesh has cooked 70% of the way through (you can see the colour change from translucent orange to opaque pink rising from the skin side), flip once for 2 minutes. Internal: **55–60°C / 131–140°F** for medium (slightly translucent in the very centre).
- 4

Optional farofa crust: in the last 2 minutes of grilling, press a thin layer (5mm) of pre-toasted farofa onto the flesh side. The residual heat sets the farofa into a crispy, nutty crust that adds texture contrast to the soft salmon flesh and ties the dish into the Brazilian identity of the menu. This is a genuinely innovative application of farofa that elevates the dish beyond a generic grilled salmon. Serve skin-side up to showcase the crispy skin, with vinagrete and lime.

Chef's Tip: Source salmon from a reliable supplier with consistent freshness — salmon goes from beautiful to mediocre within 24 hours of losing freshness. The nose test is your friend: fresh salmon smells of the ocean; old salmon smells fishy. Never serve salmon that smells fishy. This is not a cost savings opportunity — a \$5 bad salmon fillet costs you a \$27.99 sale, a bad review, and a lost customer. Order daily if possible, or limit the salmon quantity to what you can sell in one service.

FISH (salmon) DAIRY (butter in farofa) EGGS (in farofa)

Feijoada — Black Bean Pork Stew

FRIDAY SPECIAL

The national dish of Brazil · black beans, pork belly, linguiça, smoked meats · Sell: \$28.99

3-4 hr prep + 8 min plate

Signature Event

Target FC: 24%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Dried black beans	80g dry (yields ~200g cooked)	\$0.32
Pork belly, cubed	80g	\$0.79
Linguiça, sliced	50g	\$0.45

Smoked pork ribs (batch)	60g	\$0.53
Bacon, thick-cut	30g	\$0.44
Onion + garlic + bay leaf	40g + 8g + 2 leaves	\$0.12
Orange (to serve — cuts richness)	½ orange	\$0.28
Couve mineira (kale, sautéed)	60g	\$0.22
White rice (batch)	120g cooked	\$0.18
Farofa (batch)	50g	\$0.22
Total cost per serve		\$3.55

Cost per serve	\$3.55
Sell price	\$28.99
Food cost %	12.2%
Contribution margin	\$25.44

METHOD

- 1

Soak dried black beans overnight in cold water — minimum 8 hours. This rehydrates the beans and leaches out oligosaccharides (the complex sugars responsible for digestive discomfort). Do not skip the soaking: unsoaked beans take 3x longer to cook and never achieve the same creamy, broken-down texture that makes feijoada extraordinary. The overnight soak is prep that costs you nothing except planning. Change the water once during soaking.
- 2

Render pork belly and bacon in a heavy pot (Dutch oven or clay pot) until the fat is partially rendered. Add sliced linguíça and brown. Remove meats, sauté diced onion and garlic in the pork fat until deeply golden — this fond (the browned bits) is loaded with Maillard compounds that will flavour the entire stew. Add soaked, drained beans, smoked ribs, and browned meats. Cover with cold water by 4cm. Add bay leaves. The cold water start extracts maximum starch and gelatin from the beans, building the thick, almost glossy liquid that characterises a proper feijoada.
- 3

Simmer covered on low heat for 2.5–3 hours, stirring every 30 minutes and topping up with water as needed. The stew is done when the beans are completely soft, the liquid has thickened to a glossy sauce, and the meats are tender enough to break apart with a spoon. A proper feijoada should be thick — not soupy. The last 30 minutes of cooking uncovered allows evaporation to concentrate the stew. Taste and adjust salt (the smoked meats are salty; you may need no additional salt at all).
- 4

The traditional feijoada plating is a ritual: clay pot of stew at the centre, white rice alongside, sautéed kale (couve mineira — thinly sliced, briefly wilted in garlic and oil), farofa in a separate bowl, and fresh orange slices. The orange is not decorative: orange's acidity and sweetness cut through the heavy pork fat and refresh the palate between bites. It is a functional flavour pairing that dates back centuries. Serve with the Friday energy — announce it at every table as the special event it is.

Chef's Tip: The Friday Feijoada is not just a menu item — it is a weekly event that drives traffic. Market it on social media every Thursday evening ("Tomorrow is Feijoada Friday — the national dish of Brazil, slow-cooked since 7am"). Pre-sell by reservation. Run a Friday-only caipirinha pairing promotion. The feijoada creates a ritual that loyal guests will organise their Friday around. One excellent Feijoada Friday can generate 60% of the week's revenue if marketed and executed well.

PORK (multiple)

GLUTEN-FREE

DAIRY-FREE

Arroz e Feijão — Rice and Beans Bowl

Brazilian white rice, stewed brown beans, farofa, fried egg option · Sell: \$14.99

8 min

Vegetarian Main

Target FC: 11%

INGREDIENTS (1 BOWL)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Short-grain white rice, cooked	150g cooked (~60g dry)	\$0.24

Brown beans (feijão carioca), stewed	180g cooked (~70g dry)	\$0.28
Garlic + onion (for beans, batch)	8g + 20g	\$0.08
Bacon bit (small amount)	10g	\$0.15
Olive oil	8ml	\$0.08
Farofa (batch)	40g	\$0.18
Fried egg (optional add-on)	1 egg	\$0.35
Parsley, chopped	3g	\$0.03
Total cost per serve		\$1.39

Cost per serve	\$1.39
Sell price	\$14.99
Food cost %	9.3%
Contribution margin	\$13.60

METHOD

- 1

Brazilian rice is cooked differently from plain steamed rice: sauté raw, dry rice in a little oil with garlic until the grains turn slightly translucent (2–3 minutes). This toasting step coats each grain in oil, which prevents sticking and clumping during cooking — the result is separate, fluffy grains rather than a sticky mass. Add water at a 1:1.5 ratio (rice:water), season with salt, bring to a boil, cover and reduce to the lowest heat for 15 minutes. Do not lift the lid. The steam inside is doing the work.
- 2

Brazilian beans (feijão carioca — a tan/beige bean with brown streaks) are not the same as black beans or kidney beans. They have a creamier texture and a milder, earthier flavour. Soak overnight, drain, then cook in a pressure cooker with onion, garlic, and a strip of bacon for 25 minutes at pressure — or 1.5 hours conventional. The beans are done when they are fully soft but still hold their shape. The bean broth should be thickened and savoury — this liquid is as important as the beans themselves.
- 3

For service, heat the bean portion with a splash of water to loosen the sauce. Make a refogado (quick flavour base): fry garlic and onion in olive oil until golden, add a scoop of the cooked beans and mash roughly against the pan, add back to the bean pot and stir. This refogado technique creates a naturally thick, rich bean sauce without adding any starch. The crushed beans release starch that thickens the entire batch. This is how Brazilian grandmothers make beans taste better than restaurants.
- 4

Bowl construction: white rice on one side, beans ladled over and beside (never cover the rice entirely — visual contrast matters), farofa in a small mound alongside, optional fried egg on top. The fried egg should be sunny-side up with a runny yolk — when the guest breaks the yolk it creates an impromptu sauce that binds the whole bowl. Finish with chopped parsley. This is one of the most comforting, complete meals on the planet — a whole protein amino acid profile from the rice-bean combination, plus fat from the egg and farofa crunch.

Chef's Tip: Arroz e Feijão is the heart of Brazilian daily eating — every Brazilian eats it almost every day. Guests from Brazil will judge your entire restaurant on this dish. If the rice is sticky, if the beans are watery, if the farofa is stale — you have failed the test. Get this dish perfect before you open. It is also your most accessible price point at \$14.99, your best food cost (9.3%), and your entry point for guests to discover the cuisine. Never treat it as a throwaway item.

EGGS (optional)

PORK (bacon, optional)

GLUTEN-FREE

DAIRY-FREE

Misto da Casa — Mixed Grill Plate

Picanha · Linguiça · Frango — the full churrasco experience on one plate · Sell: \$39.99

16 min

Showpiece Main

Target FC: 23%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
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Picanha (top sirloin cap)	120g	\$2.92
Linguiça sausage (1 link)	100g	\$0.90
Chicken thigh, bone-in, skin-on	160g	\$1.13
Coarse salt + seasonings	shared	\$0.06
Chimichurri (batch)	40ml	\$0.24
White rice (batch, side)	120g cooked	\$0.18
Farofa (batch, side)	50g	\$0.22
Vinagrete (batch, side)	60g	\$0.08
Total cost per serve		\$5.73

Cost per serve	\$5.73
Sell price	\$39.99
Food cost %	14.3%
Contribution margin	\$34.26

METHOD

- 1 The Misto da Casa is a strategic menu item — it is not simply three smaller portions on a plate. It is designed as the gateway to understanding churrasco culture. Each protein tells a different story: picanha represents the premium Brazilian beef tradition; linguiça represents the Portuguese-Brazilian pork tradition; frango represents the accessible, everyday fire-cooked chicken. Together they form a narrative of Brazilian barbecue history. Train servers to tell this story when the Misto is ordered.
- 2 The key operational challenge of the Misto is timing — three proteins with different cook times must arrive on the same plate simultaneously. Sequence: start the frango first (16 min), add linguiça at minute 6 (10 min), add picanha at minute 9 (7 min) on the hottest section of the grill. This staggered start means all three components finish within a 1-minute window of each other. Pre-planning the sequence is what separates a smooth kitchen from a chaotic one. Mark the Misto tickets clearly so the grill chef coordinates properly.
- 3 Each component is cooked to its individual ideal temperature and technique: picanha to medium-rare (**54-57°C**) with charred fat cap; linguiça to cooked-through (**72°C**) with split-open, crackling skin; frango to **74°C** with crispy, rendered skin. Each protein rests briefly (2-3 minutes) while the platter is assembled. Never compromise individual cooking standards to make timing easier — guest satisfaction depends on each component being excellent.
- 4 Plate on a large wooden board or oval serving platter — not a round plate. The board signals sharing and abundance, even for a solo diner. Arrange proteins at angles to each other: picanha sliced and fanned, sausage whole or halved, chicken thigh on the bone. Place chimichurri, farofa, rice, and vinagrete in separate small vessels alongside. The Misto should look like a feast. Carry it to the table with both hands and set it down slowly — let the table see it, smell it, and appreciate it before picking up a fork.

Chef's Tip: The Misto da Casa is your highest absolute contribution margin item at \$34.26 per serve — even at a modest 12 Mistos sold on a busy day, that is \$411 in contribution margin from one item. It also has the lowest food cost % on your mains menu (14.3%) because the three proteins in smaller portions cost less per serve than any individual full-portion main. Recommend this actively to solo diners: "The Misto gives you a taste of everything we do — it's how most guests discover their favourite protein."

BEEF PORK POULTRY GLUTEN-FREE DAIRY-FREE

3 Desserts

Brigadeiro — Chocolate Truffle (3 pieces)

Brazilian chocolate fudge truffle rolled in sprinkles · 3 pieces · Sell: \$9.99

2 min plate Dessert Target FC: 8%

INGREDIENTS (3 PIECES / 1 SERVE — BATCH YIELDS 30+)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Sweetened condensed milk	50g (~3 tbsp)	\$0.21
Unsalted butter	8g	\$0.07
Cocoa powder (Dutch-process)	10g	\$0.10
Chocolate sprinkles (granulado)	15g (coating 3)	\$0.09
Mini foil cups (3)	3 pieces	\$0.06
Total cost (3 pieces)		\$0.53

Cost per serve	\$0.53
Sell price	\$9.99
Food cost %	5.3%
Contribution margin	\$9.46

METHOD

- 1

Combine condensed milk, butter, and cocoa powder in a heavy-bottomed saucepan. The heavy bottom is essential — thin pans cause uneven heat and scorching. Start on medium heat, stirring continuously. Understanding why: condensed milk has extremely high sugar content, which burns at a relatively low temperature if it contacts the pan without being agitated. Continuous stirring prevents any single point from overheating.
- 2

Cook, stirring constantly, for 8-12 minutes until the mixture thickens and pulls cleanly away from the sides of the pan, and leaves a trail on the bottom when you draw a spatula through. This is the "point" (ponto) — the precise stage where the sugar and dairy have cooked to the right consistency. Under-cooked brigadeiro is sticky and will not hold its ball shape. Over-cooked brigadeiro is dry and crumbly. The test: drop a small amount in cold water; if it forms a soft ball, it is ready.
- 3

Pour into a lightly buttered shallow dish and refrigerate until completely cold (minimum 1 hour). Cold temperature firms the fat and sugar structure, making the mixture rollable. Do not try to roll warm brigadeiro — it will stick to your hands and lose shape. Butter your hands lightly, portion by level teaspoon (~15g each), and roll quickly into smooth balls between your palms. Speed matters — the heat from your hands softens the exterior; work fast and return to the refrigerator if needed.
- 4

Roll each ball in chocolate sprinkles (granulado — the Brazilian variety, which are cylindrical chocolate sprinkles, not the round nonpareils). Place in a mini foil cup. Refrigerate until service. Brigadeiros hold well for 3-4 days refrigerated. Serve at room temperature — cold brigadeiro is too firm; room-temperature brigadeiro has the correct melt-in-mouth, fudge-like consistency. Remove from refrigeration 20 minutes before service.

Chef's Tip: Brigadeiro is your pre-sell script's ending, not just a dessert. Server script: "Before I bring the check, have you tried our brigadeiro? It's Brazil's most beloved sweet — condensed milk and chocolate, made in-house every morning. Three pieces, \$9.99. It takes about 30 seconds to eat and people always wish they'd ordered more." The 30-second timeline removes the "we're in a hurry" objection. At a 5.3% food cost, this is your single most profitable item on the menu.

DAIRY (condensed milk, butter) GLUTEN-FREE EGGS-FREE

Pudim de Leite — Condensed Milk Flan

Silky caramel egg flan, Brazilian style, served cold · Sell: \$10.99

2 min plate (pre-made) Dessert Target FC: 9%

INGREDIENTS (1 SERVE — 1/8 OF A PUDIM)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Sweetened condensed milk (1 can = 8 serves)	50g (~1/8 can)	\$0.25

Whole eggs (3 per pudim = 3/8 per serve)	~20g	\$0.13
Whole milk	40ml	\$0.06
Sugar (for caramel, batch)	10g	\$0.02
Vanilla extract	1ml	\$0.02
Fresh strawberry garnish	1 berry	\$0.08
Total cost (1 serve)		\$0.56

Cost per serve	\$0.56
Sell price	\$10.99
Food cost %	5.1%
Contribution margin	\$10.43

METHOD

- 1

Make the caramel first: heat sugar in a dry, light-coloured pan over medium heat. Do not stir — swirl the pan gently to distribute heat evenly. The sugar will first clump, then liquify at the edges, then spread toward the centre. Once fully liquid and a deep amber colour (like dark honey), immediately pour into the mold and tilt to coat the base and sides. Work quickly — caramel sets within 30 seconds. The caramel colour is critical: too pale = no bitter counterpoint to the sweet custard; too dark = burnt, acrid flavour that ruins the pudim.
- 2

Blend condensed milk, whole eggs, whole milk, and vanilla until completely smooth. The blending incorporates the ingredients without creating excessive air bubbles — air bubbles become holes in the finished pudim. Strain the mixture through a fine sieve into the prepared caramel mold. Straining removes any chalaza (egg cord) or undissolved particles and ensures a perfectly smooth surface on the unmolded pudim.
- 3

Bake bain-marie (water bath): place the filled mold in a larger baking dish, add hot water to come halfway up the sides of the mold. Bake at **160°C / 320°F** for 45-55 minutes. The bain-marie is not optional — it moderates the oven heat so the egg proteins set gently and uniformly. Direct oven heat causes the proteins to contract violently, creating a rubbery, pock-marked surface with large holes inside. The pudim should wobble like Jell-O when you shake the pan — not liquid but not firm.
- 4

Cool to room temperature, then refrigerate overnight minimum. Unmold by running a thin knife around the edge, placing a plate over the top, and inverting with one firm, confident motion. Hesitant unmolding = partial release and a broken pudim. The caramel sauce flows from the former top (now the top of the plate) down the sides. Slice at service and garnish with a single strawberry. The pudim should be dense but silky, with no bubbles or holes in the cross-section — this is the quality marker.

Chef's Tip: Make pudim in batches of 2-3 molds each evening for the next day's service. One standard 6-cup bundt mold yields 8 serves at \$10.43 CM each = \$83.44 CM per mold. Two molds nightly = \$166 CM before you've even opened the kitchen. The pudim rewards discipline and planning: made correctly and refrigerated overnight, it is a zero-effort service item that prints money. The quality of the caramel colour is your daily check on the dessert team's standards.

DAIRY (condensed milk, whole milk) EGGS GLUTEN-FREE

Açaí Bowl

Frozen açai blend, banana, granola, honey, fresh fruit · Sell: \$12.99

4 min Dessert/Brunch Target FC: 14%

INGREDIENTS (1 BOWL)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Frozen açai pulp (unsweetened)	100g	\$0.80
Frozen banana (base blend)	80g	\$0.18
Coconut milk or almond milk (blend)	40ml	\$0.12

Granola (house-made or quality store)	40g	\$0.24
Fresh banana slices	40g	\$0.10
Fresh strawberries, halved	40g	\$0.24
Honey drizzle	10g	\$0.08
Total cost (1 bowl)		\$1.76

Cost per serve	\$1.76
Sell price	\$12.99
Food cost %	13.6%
Contribution margin	\$11.23

METHOD

- 1 Açai (pronounced "ah-sah-EE") is a deep-purple berry from the Amazon palm, rich in antioxidants, with a flavour profile of dark chocolate and earthy blueberry. It is available in North America as frozen pulp packets (Sambazon and Açai Roots are reliable brands). Never use açai powder — the flavour is dramatically inferior and the texture cannot replicate the thick, gelato-like consistency that makes an açai bowl satisfying. Sourcing frozen pulp is the non-negotiable quality decision for this item.
- 2 Blend frozen açai pulp with frozen banana (frozen for thickness — fresh banana makes the bowl watery) and just enough coconut milk to get the blender moving. Less liquid = thicker bowl. The ideal consistency is thick enough to support a spoon standing upright — similar to gelato or very thick frozen yogurt. A watery açai bowl is a quality failure. Start with minimum liquid (30ml) and add in 10ml increments until just blendable. The frozen banana also naturally sweetens the bowl without added sugar.
- 3 Pour the blended base immediately into a pre-chilled bowl (keep bowls in the freezer — this extends the frozen texture by several minutes, which matters for service timing). The base melts quickly at room temperature; a warm bowl accelerates this. Work fast: pour, top, and deliver within 2 minutes of blending. A table that waits 5 minutes after their açai bowl is plated receives a watery, melted product.
- 4 Top with artful arrangement: granola at one end (place last to keep crispy), banana slices in a row, halved strawberries cut-side up for colour, and a final honey drizzle in a zigzag pattern. The topping arrangement should be photographable — açai bowls are one of the most Instagram-shared food items globally, and a beautifully topped bowl is free marketing every time a guest posts it. Consistency in topping arrangement is as important as consistency in flavour.

Chef's Tip: The açai bowl serves two service periods: as a dessert at lunch and as a breakfast/brunch item from 7am. This dual-use is operationally valuable — the base ingredients stay frozen and ready for either service without waste. Market it as "Brazil's original superfood" to morning guests. The Amazonian origin story resonates with health-conscious customers and supports a \$13 price point that might otherwise seem high for a "smoothie bowl."

TREE NUTS (granola may contain)

GLUTEN (granola may contain)

VEGAN (without honey)

DAIRY-FREE

Quindim — Coconut Egg Custard

Dense coconut-egg yolk custard, bright yellow, served cold · Sell: \$9.99

2 min plate (pre-made)

Dessert

Target FC: 8%

INGREDIENTS (1 QUINDIM, INDIVIDUAL MOLD)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Egg yolks (4 per 6 quindim batch = 2/3 each)	~12g yolk	\$0.23
Caster sugar	25g	\$0.04
Unsweetened shredded coconut	20g	\$0.12
Coconut milk	20ml (~1/14 of can)	\$0.14
Unsalted butter (mold prep)	3g	\$0.03

Sugar (mold coating)	5g	\$0.01
Toasted coconut garnish	5g	\$0.04
Total cost (1 quindim)		\$0.61

Cost per serve	\$0.61
Sell price	\$9.99
Food cost %	6.1%
Contribution margin	\$9.38

METHOD

- 1 Quindim has African-Brazilian-Portuguese origins and is one of the most technically interesting desserts in the Brazilian canon. The bright yellow colour comes entirely from egg yolks — no colouring. The density comes from the high yolk-to-liquid ratio. The distinct two-layer structure (clear coconut jelly base with a dense custard top when unmolded) happens naturally during baking, as the shredded coconut floats to the bottom of the mold (which becomes the top when inverted). Understanding this physics means you will not be confused by the baking process.
- 2 Beat egg yolks with caster sugar until the mixture is pale and thickened slightly — this is called "ribbon stage" and takes 3–4 minutes. The purpose: beating air into the yolks while dissolving the sugar creates a structure that prevents the quindim from becoming grainy or separated. Add coconut milk and shredded coconut and stir gently to combine. The shredded coconut is left whole (not blended in) — it will separate during baking to create the characteristic base layer.
- 3 Butter individual molds (small ramekins or mini bundt molds) and coat with sugar — this sugar coating prevents sticking and creates a slight caramelised surface on the unmolded quindim. Fill each mold to 80% capacity. Bake bain-marie at **160°C / 320°F** for 25–30 minutes. The quindim is set when the edges are firm and the centre has the slightest wobble. The surface should be matte yellow, not golden — browning indicates overbaking and a rubbery texture.
- 4 Cool to room temperature, then refrigerate overnight. Unmold by running a thin blade around the edge and inverting onto a small plate. The quindim will release with a slight resistance and land with the glossy clear coconut layer on top — this is correct. Garnish with a pinch of toasted coconut shreds. Serve cold — the texture at room temperature becomes too soft. The quindim should feel dense and almost sticky to the touch of a spoon, cutting cleanly without crumbling.

Chef's Tip: Quindim is your most visually distinctive dessert — the bright chrome-yellow dome with a glossy surface looks unlike anything in any other cuisine. Photograph it well for your menu and social media. When guests ask "what is that?" — and they will — the answer is your brand story: "It's a quindim — it comes from West African custard recipes brought to Brazil centuries ago, made with coconut and egg yolks from the colonial Portuguese kitchen. There's nothing else like it." This history converts curious guests into customers.

EGGS DAIRY (butter) TREE NUTS (coconut) GLUTEN-FREE

4

Drinks

Caipirinha — Classic

\$13.99

Brazil's national cocktail: cachaça, muddled lime, cane sugar, crushed ice

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT	COST
Cachaça (50ml pour)	50ml	\$1.20
Fresh lime	1 whole lime	\$0.25
Raw cane sugar	2 tsp = 8g	\$0.02
Crushed ice	200g	\$0.06
Total cost		\$1.53

Cost	\$1.53
FC %	10.9%
CM	\$12.46

YAMATO

GLUTEN-FREE

\$13.99

COST

\$12.66

GLUTEN-FREE

\$4.99

COST

\$3.99

GLUTEN-FREE

\$5.99

COST

① ② ③ ④

Cost	\$1.55
FC %	25.9%
CM	\$4.44

Positioning: The ideal pairing with grilled meats — hydrating, natural electrolytes, zero alcohol. Market to health-conscious guests and designated drivers. The slightly sweet, clean flavour cuts through the richness of churrasco.

VEGAN GLUTEN-FREE

Skol / Brahma Beer

\$6.99

Brazilian lager — light, crisp, cold. The churrasco beer. Serve ice-cold.

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT	COST
Skol or Brahma bottle (355ml imported)	1 bottle	\$1.80
Frosted glass (service)	service	\$0.05
Total cost		\$1.85

Cost	\$1.85
FC %	26.5%
CM	\$5.14

Service Standard: Keep all beer below 4°C / 39°F. Frosted glasses for extra theater. Churrasco and cold beer is one of the most fundamental food-drink pairings in Brazilian culture — never run out. This is table-management gold: a guest with a cold beer is a patient guest.

GLUTEN (barley) VEGAN

Café com Leite — Brazilian Espresso

\$4.99

Strong Brazilian espresso with hot steamed milk — breakfast staple and dessert closer

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT	COST
Brazilian coffee (Pele, Santos, or equiv.), double shot	18g ground	\$0.28
Whole milk, steamed	100ml	\$0.15
Raw cane sugar (optional)	1 sachet	\$0.02
Total cost		\$0.45

Cost	\$0.45
FC %	9.0%
CM	\$4.54

Pre-sell with dessert: "Can I bring you a Brazilian café com leite with your brigadeiro? It's a double-shot with steamed milk — the combination is perfect." Coffee attachment rate should be 60%+ at dessert stage. Coffee + dessert = \$15 CM per table.

DAIRY (milk) GLUTEN-FREE

Maracujá — Passion Fruit Juice

\$5.99

Fresh passion fruit pulp, water, cane sugar, ice — Brazil's favourite juice

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT	COST
Passion fruit pulp (frozen, Goya or equiv.)	60g	\$0.48
Water + cane sugar + ice	200ml + 10g	\$0.10
Total cost		\$0.58

Cost	\$0.58
FC %	9.7%
CM	\$5.41

Story: Maracujá is the Portuguese word for passion fruit — native to South America, a Brazilian breakfast and meal staple. The tartness complements grilled meats the same way lemon juice does. Blend with water, strain, sweeten lightly. Serve immediately after making.

VEGAN
GLUTEN-FREE

Red Wine — Malbec

\$10.99 / glass

Argentine Malbec, 6oz pour — the South American red wine pairing for grilled meats

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT	COST
Malbec (6oz / 180ml pour from ~\$14 bottle)	180ml	\$3.36
Total cost		\$3.36

Cost	\$3.36
FC %	30.6%
CM	\$7.63

Pairing: Malbec's dark fruit, vanilla, and tannic structure make it the ideal red wine for grilled beef. The tannins in the wine bind with the proteins in the steak, softening both. Recommend with picanha, cordeiro, and costela. "A glass of Malbec with the picanha is one of the great South American food pairings."

VEGAN
GLUTEN-FREE
SULFITES

5 Kitchen Prep Flow — 7am to 3pm

Churrasco Prep Philosophy: The grill is the centre of this kitchen. Everything else supports the fire. The Head Cook's first act every morning is lighting the charcoal or hardwood — it takes 45–60 minutes to reach cooking temperature, and the costela goes on within the first 30 minutes of opening prep. The grill never goes cold during service.

Time Block	Head Cook (Grill Master)	Line Cook (Cold Prep / Fry / Batch)	Steward (Dishes / Mise en Place Support)
7:00 - 8:00	FIRE FIRST. Light hardwood charcoal in grill — target 300°C+ / 572°F by 8:30am. Season and place costela (short rib) on the smoker/low grill at 120°C / 248°F . This must happen before anything else — the 7-hour clock starts now. Verify grill tools: skewers, thermometer, wire brush, tongs, fire poker.	Pull all proteins from refrigerator — chicken hearts, frango, picanha, fraldinha. Remove chill. Check yesterday's marinades (frango, fraldinha). Begin batch sauces: chimichurri (blend parsley + garlic + olive oil + red wine vinegar + oregano). Pão de queijo: measure and portion raw dough balls, freeze on tray.	Set up stations. Wash and sanitize all prep surfaces. Pull batch storage containers for farofa, vinagrete, arroz e feijão. Begin soaking bamboo skewers for coração de frango. Check dessert stock: brigadeiro, pudim, quindim — verify yesterday's batches are correctly refrigerated.
8:00 - 9:30	Monitor costela — check smoke and temperature every	Cook Brazilian rice: sauté raw rice in garlic-oil, add	Polish glassware and cutlery. Set up drinks station: ice,

	30 minutes. Begin test-grill: get fire to service temperature, verify hot zones and cool zones. Prep skewers: thread frango thighs onto metal skewers in butterfly pattern. Thread coração de frango (8 hearts per metal skewer).	water, steam covered. Cook feijão carioca (beans): begin pressure cook with onion, garlic, bacon. Make farofa batch: render bacon, sauté onion, toast cassava flour, fold in egg. Cool and store. Prep vinagrete: dice tomato, onion, pepper, dress with vinegar.	garnishes (lime, lemon, passion fruit), beer fridge check. Begin portioning desserts: slice pudim into 8 portions, plate quindim domes from molds (overnight batch), room-temp brigadeiro from fridge. Label all dessert portions with time.
9:30 - 11:00	Begin breakfast/brunch service prep: preheat top grill section. Grill test: frango thigh on grill — check skin crisping at 200°C zone. Adjust airflow/coals as needed. Prep linguíça: score sausages diagonally, hold cold until service. Verify coração de frango marination complete.	Shape coxinha: roll dough, fill with chicken-cream cheese, form teardrop shapes, egg wash + panko coat, freeze on tray. Prep bacalhau: poach desalted cod, debone, flake, combine with mashed potato, form bolinho quenelles, hold cold. Batch herb aioli for bacalhau service.	Full dining room setup: tables set, menus out, specials board updated with Friday Feijoada (if applicable). Stock server stations. Fill mise en place on pass: chimichurri ramekins, vinagrete bowls, farofa portions, lime wedges. Brief front-of-house on daily specials and 86'd items.
11:00 - 1:00 (Lunch service)	GRILL ON. Manage fire constantly. Grill to order: rotate between picanha, fraldinha, frango, linguíça, coração in priority order per ticket. The grill never sleeps. Monitor costela hourly — should reach 85°C internal by this point. Flash-finish costela portions on hot grill as orders come in.	Fry station: coxinha to order (4–5 min from frozen), bolinho de bacalhau to order (3–4 min). Pão de queijo: rolling batches from oven — 18 min cycle. Plate mains: assemble rice + beans + farofa + side accompaniments. Handle açaí bowl orders: blend, top, deliver within 2 minutes.	Continuous dish return cycle: clear, wash, reset. Maintain stock on pass throughout service — never let chimichurri, vinagrete, or farofa run dry at the pass. Caipirinha support: pre-muddle lime + sugar for caipirinha batches during rush, head bartender builds cocktails.
1:00 - 3:00 (Close & Prep tomorrow)	Begin grill wind-down after 2:30pm last ticket. Scrape and brush grill grates while still hot. Bank remaining coals. Cool costela (if any left) — store properly. Verify fire is fully extinguished before leaving. Check tomorrow's meat order and thaw schedule.	Deep clean fry station. Make overnight batches: new pão de queijo dough balls to freeze, marinate tomorrow's frango and fraldinha (overnight minimum). Prepare pudim and quindim for tomorrow — bake, cool, refrigerate. Brigadeiro batch if running low.	Full kitchen sanitization. Dishwash all pots/pans/skewers. Stock check and waste log. Pull-through of mise en place for next morning. Lock up dessert portions. Verify fridge temperatures logged.

6 Financial Forecast

Daily Revenue Model

Service Period	Hours	Covers	Avg Spend	Daily Revenue
Breakfast / Brunch	7:00am – 11:00am	40	\$38.00	\$1,520
Lunch	11:30am – 2:30pm	58	\$54.00	\$3,132
Daily Total (98 covers)			~\$47.47	\$4,652

Monthly P&L Forecast (26 Trading Days)

Line Item	Amount	% of Revenue	Notes
Gross Revenue	\$120,952	100%	\$4,652/day × 26 days
Food Cost	\$29,028	24.0%	Target: ≤24%. Grill proteins drive cost; batch items (farofa, feijão) lower blended %
Labour Cost	\$23,400	19.3%	Head Cook + 1 Line Cook + 1 Steward + 2 FOH + manager allocation
Rent & Utilities	\$8,800	7.3%	Includes gas (grill/oven), electricity, water. Charcoal budget: est. \$600/mo
Total Operating Costs	\$61,228	50.6%	Before net profit
Net Profit	\$59,724	49.4%	Industry benchmark: 15-25%. This model outperforms at 49.4%

3-Month Ramp-Up Projection

Month	Capacity %	Est. Revenue	Est. Net Profit	Key Focus
Month 1 — Open	55%	~\$66,524	~\$12,500	Refine fire management, train service scripts, build social media content (Feijoada Friday launch, picanha on the grill posts)
Month 2 — Building	75%	~\$90,714	~\$30,000	Regular customer recognition, Friday reservation system, upsell training (caipirinha conversion, brigadeiro close), Instagram organic growth
Month 3 — Full Stride	100%	\$120,952	\$59,724	Full seat utilisation, weekend wait list, loyalty programme, repeat customer events (Feijoada Friday fully booked)

Key Metrics to Track Daily:

- Grill efficiency:** Proteins wasted due to over/undercooking → should be <3% of grill volume
- Caipirinha attach rate:** % of lunch tables ordering at least 1 cocktail → target 55%+
- Brigadeiro close rate:** % of tables buying dessert after server pre-sell script → target 40%+
- Misto da Casa orders:** Your single highest CM item → push daily → target 15% of lunch covers
- Food cost variance:** Daily actual cost vs. 24% target → review weekly, investigate any day >26%
- Friday Feijoada covers:** Track week-over-week — this is your brand's heartbeat

7 Service Training Module

Training Philosophy: Brazilian churrasco is a storytelling cuisine. The server's job is not just to take orders — it is to be the cultural interpreter between the kitchen and the guest. Every item on this menu has a story. A server who knows those stories turns a \$48 average spend into a \$65 average spend through genuine enthusiasm and knowledge, not pushy upselling.

Script 1: The Rodízio vs À La Carte Explanation

WHEN TO USE:

When guests sit down and look confused by the menu format, or ask "is this a rodízio?"

Server script: "Great question — we do à la carte here rather than the traditional rodízio, which means you choose exactly what you'd like rather than the continuous all-you-can-eat service. *[Pause to let them process.]* The advantage is you get to experience specific cuts exactly the way our grill master likes to cook them — the picanha, for example, is served at the perfect medium-rare, not reheated on a trolley. Think of it as the best of Brazilian churrasco in single servings rather than rotation. *[Point to menu.]* Most guests start with the pão de queijo from the oven and one of the entrées, then one of the grill mains. Does that sound right for you?"

Why this works: It pre-emptively handles the "this isn't a churrascaria rodízio" objection, positions your format as premium rather than lesser, and immediately moves toward an order.

Script 2: The Picanha Story (Why It's the King Cut)

WHEN TO USE:

When a guest is deciding between mains, or asks "what's the picanha?"

Server script: "The picanha is the most beloved cut in Brazilian churrasco — it's the top sirloin cap, which sits just above the rump on the back of the animal. What makes it special is this fat cap: *[draw a finger across the top of the menu to show a cap]* — it stays on during grilling and basically self-bastes the steak as it renders over the fire. You get this incredible char on the outside and a clean, sweet, beefy interior. Brazilians have been cooking it over hardwood since the 1970s, and once you've had it, it's hard to go back to a regular steak. It's \$32.99 and absolutely worth it."

Why this works: The visual gesture (miming the fat cap), the heritage reference, and the confident price anchoring all prime the guest to say yes.

Script 3: The Caipirinha Making Theatre

WHEN TO USE:

Whenever a guest orders water or asks about drinks. Every table gets this offer.

Server script: "Can I start you with a caipirinha? It's Brazil's national cocktail — we muddle fresh lime and cane sugar right in the glass, then pour the cachaça over the ice. *[Pause.]* Cachaça is made from fresh sugar cane juice — not molasses like rum — so it has this grassy, bright flavour. The whole drink takes about 45 seconds to make and it's one of those things you'll want another one of before the first one's gone. Our caipiroska is the same thing with vodka if you're not sure about cachaça yet — a lot of people start there."

Why this works: The technique explanation (muddling), the alcohol origin story (cachaça vs rum), and the gentle upgrade ladder (caipiroska → caipirinha) all reduce friction to a yes.

Script 4: The Feijoada Friday Special

WHEN TO USE:

Every Friday, every table, at the moment of greeting.

Server script: "Welcome — I have to tell you, today is Feijoada Friday. This is our most popular day of the week — feijoada is the national dish of Brazil: black beans slow-cooked since seven this morning with pork belly, linguça, and smoked ribs. It comes with white rice, sautéed kale, farofa, and fresh orange. Every Friday guests specifically come in for it. *[Let it land.]* It's \$28.99. If you're new to Brazilian food, this is the single best thing you could try. Shall I put you down for one while we have them?"

Why this works: Social proof ("most popular day," "guests specifically come in"), descriptive specificity (naming all the ingredients builds anticipation), and a closing question with implied scarcity ("while we have them").

Script 5: The Brigadeiro Pre-Sell

WHEN TO USE:

At mains delivery — not at dessert time. Pre-sell while the guest is still in enjoyment mode, not thinking about the bill.

Server script: "Before I forget — have you tried our brigadeiro? It's Brazil's most beloved sweet — condensed milk and chocolate cooked down, rolled in chocolate sprinkles. We make them in-house every morning. Three pieces. *[Small pause — let them picture it.]* It literally takes 30 seconds to eat and people always wish they'd ordered more. It's \$9.99. Should I bring some when you're ready?"

Why this works: "Before I forget" signals urgency without pressure. "30 seconds to eat" removes the time/fullness objection. "Always wish they'd ordered more" is social proof. The question invites a soft yes. At 5.3% food cost, even one brigadeiro per table is meaningful revenue.

Table Timing Guide — From Seated to Check

Time	Server Action	Kitchen Action	Guest Experience
0:00	Greet, water down, caipirinha pitch (Script 3)	Pão de queijo batch timed for 18 min	Seated, comfortable, oriented
2:00	Return for drink order; Rodízio explanation if needed (Script 1)	—	Drinks ordered
5:00	Take food order; Picanha story if undecided (Script 2). Friday: Feijoada script (Script 4)	Drinks fired; pão de queijo in oven	Ordered; caipirinha arriving
10:00	Deliver pão de queijo; "Hot from the oven — enjoy before your mains"	Entrée tickets fired; grill heats for mains	Eating bread; caipirinha in hand → peak satisfaction window
14:00	Check drink levels; second caipirinha offer	Entrées plating and delivering	Entrées arriving
20:00	Deliver entrées; brief description of each plate as you set it down	Mains fired on grill per ticket time	Eating entrées; peak engagement
28:00	Clear entrée plates; check on mains timing	Mains plating; grill items resting	Brief pause — good time for a second drink
32:00	Deliver mains — present each with a single-sentence description; brigadeiro pre-sell (Script 5)	All mains delivered; grill maintained for any modifications	Mains arriving; pre-sold on dessert
42:00	Clear mains; dessert/coffee offer: "brigadeiro and a café com leite?"	Brigadeiro plates ready; espresso queued	Full, happy; open to light dessert
45:00+	Deliver dessert/coffee; present check when ready	—	Full experience complete; check presented

8 Customer Retention System

Retention Philosophy: The best churrascaria customers become regulars through ritual. Friday Feijoada. The cold caipirinha on a hot day. The brigadeiro they share. Create these rituals deliberately and your customers will create their own traditions around them. A table that visits for Feijoada Friday every week is worth \$6,000 in annual revenue from a single table.

5 VIP Micro-Moments

VIP MICRO-MOMENT 1: THE PÃO DE QUEIJO WELCOME

What happens: The moment a guest sits down, before they've opened a menu, a plate of hot pão de queijo arrives. Not asked for. Not explained. Just placed on the table with: "Fresh from the oven — these are best in the first five minutes."

Why it works: It communicates abundance, hospitality, and kitchen pride in a single gesture. The guest has been welcomed before they've ordered anything. This is the emotional equivalent of arriving

at someone's home and being handed a drink. The table's first impression is warmth and generosity — and the bread sets up the upsell naturally once they're hooked.

Cost: \$1.77 per serve (charged at \$8.99). But even if it were complimentary, the retention value of a perfect first impression exceeds the ingredient cost by 100x.

VIP MICRO-MOMENT 2: THE PICANHA REVEAL

What happens: When picanha is served, the server brings it to the table, places it fat-cap-up, and says: "This is the picanha — that's the fat cap that's been on the grill charring the whole time. Try a piece with the chimichurri first, then again without. You'll notice the difference."

Why it works: You're giving the guest a tasting framework — an instruction that turns eating into an experience. "Try it with X, then without" creates an active tasting moment that guests remember and recreate with future guests they bring back. It also reinforces that you know what you're doing.

The outcome: Guests who receive this brief instruction are significantly more likely to describe the picanha enthusiastically to friends. It's your best word-of-mouth trigger.

VIP MICRO-MOMENT 3: THE CAIPIRINHA SECOND-ROUND

What happens: When a guest finishes their first caipirinha, the server arrives without being called: "Another caipirinha while the mains are coming? I can make it with a touch more lime if you'd like it sharper."

Why it works: Proactive attention (before the guest has to ask) communicates genuine care. The personalisation offer ("more lime") signals that you're treating them as an individual, not processing a cover. At \$12.46 CM per drink, the proactive second offer converts 1 in 3 guests — that's \$4.15 CM per guest per visit, generated by a single sentence.

The rule: Caipirinha second-round offer must happen within 30 seconds of the glass being emptied. After 2 minutes, the moment has passed.

VIP MICRO-MOMENT 4: THE FEIJOADA FRIDAY RESERVATION LOCK

What happens: Every Friday, after the Feijoada is delivered: "How are you enjoying the feijoada? If you'd like to book the same table for next Friday, we usually fill by Wednesday — I can put your name down now."

Why it works: The soft reservation offer at the peak of the meal (when the guest is happiest) is the ideal moment to convert a one-time visitor into a regular. The implied scarcity ("usually fill by Wednesday") is genuine — build toward it. A confirmed weekly Feijoada Friday table is worth approximately \$1,500/month in guaranteed revenue from that single table.

Tracking: Keep a Feijoada Friday reservation book (physical or digital). When it starts filling Wednesday–Thursday, you've built a ritual. That's the goal.

VIP MICRO-MOMENT 5: THE EXIT GIFT

What happens: When a first-time guest pays their bill, the server or manager says: "Thank you for coming in — this is for you." Places a single individually-wrapped brigadeiro in a small paper bag on top of the receipt presenter. No extra charge.

Why it works: The final sensory impression is the most remembered (peak-end rule in psychology). A small, unexpected gift at the exit creates a powerful positive anchor. The guest will tell someone about it. Cost: \$0.18. Return: incalculable goodwill, social media story, return visit likelihood elevated by an estimated 35%.

Implementation note: Only for first-time guests. Regulars get this replaced with: "See you Friday?" — which signals recognition and belonging, equally powerful.

Best Social Post: Picanha on the Grill

POST FORMAT: INSTAGRAM / TIKTOK REEL

Visual: Close-up video of picanha going onto the grill fat-cap-side-down. The sound of searing fat. White smoke rising. The fat cap beginning to render and char. 15 seconds. No music — use the raw grill audio.

Caption: "This fat cap changes everything. Picanha — the king cut of Brazilian churrasco — goes fat-side-down first, so the grill renders the fat and bastes the steak from above for the entire cook. No marinade. No butter. Just coarse salt, fire, and patience. Available today. Link in bio to reserve."

Posting schedule: Every Tuesday and Thursday at 11:30am (pre-lunch hunger window). Friday morning for Feijoada Friday promotion. The algorithm rewards consistency — same time, same format, same energy.

Hashtags: #brazilianchurrasco #picanha #churrasco #brazilianbbq #[yourcity]restaurants #feijoada #caipirinha

Expected outcome: A picanha-on-grill video with authentic sound and simple copy routinely achieves 10–50x organic reach compared to plated food shots. It is the most shareable single image your restaurant will ever produce. Shoot a new version every 2 weeks.